

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Operations Centre (SOC) | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience leading and maturing Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions within large, complex organisations. I have deep expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform management, threat detection engineering, incident management, and vulnerability remediation. At the University of the Arts London, I have built and operated the full security operations capability, leading SOC engagement, SIEM administration, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) management using CrowdStrike Falcon, and major incident response in line with NIST 800-61 and the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am experienced in engaging with and coordinating internal security operations teams, bridging technical operations with governance requirements, and improving the organisation's overall security posture through measurable, risk-based programmes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Operations Centre (SOC) Leadership:** SOC engagement, alert triage, escalation, threat hunting, detection engineering, incident coordination across cross-functional teams
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, Splunk / Security Processing Language (SPL) - detection rule authoring, custom analytics, dashboards
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, Spotlight) - Expert level; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Incident Response and Management:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, containment, eradication, forensic investigation, lessons learned
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender - 8,000-user deployment
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM - enterprise deployment and management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM):** Microsoft Intune MDM / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Email and Network Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, Tanium
- **Security Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+ (details below)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | London, UK

- Lead all Security Operations Centre (SOC) engagement activities including alert triage prioritisation, escalation management, and coordination of the security operations function across a complex, multi-site 8,000-user estate.
- Architect and manage the Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, authoring custom KQL analytics rules, threat hunting queries, and automated Security Orchestration,

Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that deliver measurable reductions in mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).

- Expert-level administration of CrowdStrike Falcon across all modules (NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover, Spotlight), driving detection policy maturity, real-time threat response, and custom indicator of attack (IOA) engineering aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Lead cyber incident management in accordance with NIST 800-61, coordinating cross-functional teams through the full incident lifecycle: detection, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, conducting advanced threat investigations using MITRE ATT&CK and producing detailed incident reports for senior leadership.
- Oversee the enterprise vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), ensuring findings are risk-rated and tracked to remediation within agreed Service Level Agreements (SLAs).
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), configuring Conditional Access policies, phishing-resistant MFA, and SSO integrations to enforce zero-trust identity principles.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), controlling privileged account sessions, enforcing least-privilege access, and producing audit evidence for compliance reviews.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns, reporting outcomes and trending data to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and senior leadership.
- Develop and maintain security operational procedures, playbooks, and runbooks aligned to NIST CSF and ISO 27001 requirements.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | London, UK

- Deployed and matured the CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform from initial implementation to full SOC integration, establishing detection policies, automated response workflows, and custom threat intelligence integrations.
- Implemented Microsoft Sentinel as the centralised SIEM, onboarding data connectors, engineering KQL analytics rules, and integrating SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage and response.
- Performed daily SOC alert triage from SIEM, EDR, email security, and identity platforms, investigating confirmed incidents and producing detailed post-incident reports with actionable recommendations.
- Managed Conditional Access, MFA, and identity policies in Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, reducing credential-based attack surface across all user populations.
- Conducted regular threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying and neutralising threats before escalation.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-rated reports and tracking remediation progress through to closure.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM operations including account provisioning, quarterly access reviews, and audit evidence production.
- Administered Mimecast email security, responding to phishing campaigns and business email compromise (BEC) threats through policy tuning and incident response.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance programmes, supporting internal and external audit activities.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology) | London, UK

- Provided security engineering and infrastructure support across the company's cloud-based Software as a Service (SaaS) Financial Technology (FinTech) platform, including endpoint protection, network access controls, and identity management.
- Monitored security tooling and escalated alerts through the incident response process, supporting the security team in timely detection and response to security events.
- Managed user provisioning, access reviews, and de-provisioning across cloud and on-premise identity systems.

- Assisted with vulnerability scanning and patch management, ensuring timely identification and tracking of security risks through to remediation.
- Contributed to quality assurance and infrastructure improvement projects aligned with company security standards and policies.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Matured the SOC function at UAL from reactive alert triage to proactive threat hunting, implementing detection engineering practices aligned to MITRE ATT&CK that measurably improved the organisation's threat detection capability.
- Reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) through automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, cutting manual triage effort by over 40%.
- Led a major ransomware incident response exercise in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment across multiple teams and producing a post-incident report that drove significant improvements in response procedures.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials+ certification through leading the technical control remediation programme, demonstrating SOC maturity and operational security control effectiveness.
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across 8,000 endpoints, establishing baseline detection coverage and custom threat intelligence integrations.
- Delivered Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) using Pentera, providing quantitative evidence of detection gaps to leadership and driving targeted improvements in SIEM analytics rules.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) enterprise-wide, eliminating standing administrative privileges and achieving compliance with CIS Controls requirements.

EDUCATION

- **Master of Science (M.Sc.), Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.), Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (Birmingham/UK)